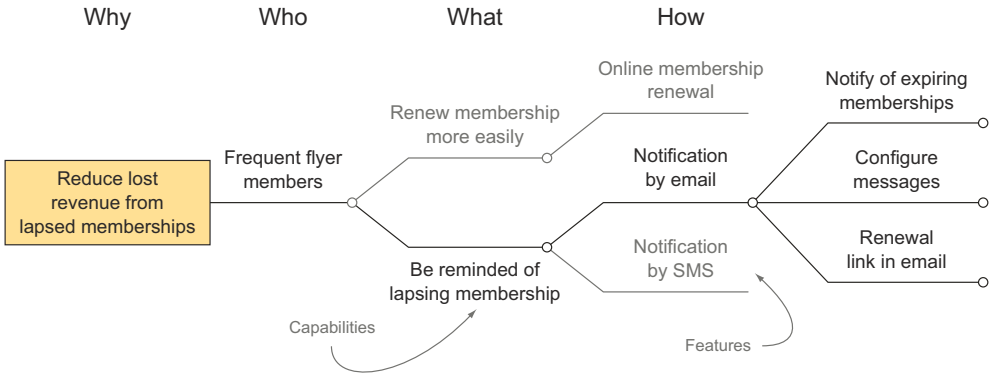


Figure 4.11 You can break large features down into smaller, more manageable ones.

One of the features you discovered for this requirement was "Email notification of lapsing membership." This is a fairly large piece of work, so you could break it down into stories like the following:

- Send notification emails to members whose membership will finish within a month.
- Configure notification message texts.
- Open renewal page from the notification email.

Although each of these stories adds business value in its own way, these stories aren't designed to be deployed into production independently. But they do provide great opportunities for getting useful feedback from stakeholders.

For example, suppose you're working on the following story:

```
Story: Send notification emails to members whose membership will finish
     within a month
In order to increase retention rates for our Frequent Flyer program
As a sales manager
I want members to be notified a month before their memberships finish
```

When you show the implementation of this story to the Flying High sales manager, the conversation goes something like this:

> You: And this is how the email notification works. When their membership is about to expire, they receive an email that looks like this.
>
> John the Sales Manager: Looks good. And what about the follow-up email?
>
> You: Is there a follow-up email?
>
> John: Of course. Bill from marketing wants a follow-up email that will include a discount offer of some kind to encourage ex-members to come back.
>
> You: And is the discount always the same?
>
> John: No, Bill needs to be able to change it depending on his latest marketing strategy. We talked about configuring the messages last time.